

Emmeline Pankhurst

The woman who gave **WOMEN** a voice

At a time when women should be seen and not heard, Emmeline Pankhurst got herself seen, and she was certainly heard.

A fighting start

Emmeline was born in 1858 in Manchester, England. Her family had a history of **RADICAL POLITICS**, and her husband, Richard Pankhurst, a supporter of *women's rights*, wrote an act of parliament that allowed married women to keep their own property.

By the way... not every country had to fight like we did. Women were given the vote in New Zealand in 1893, and in 1902 in Australia.

Taking a stand

In 1889, Emmeline founded the Women's Franchise League, who **campaign**ed for women to have the right to vote in local elections. In 1903, Pankhurst helped to create the more aggressive Women's Social and Political Union (WSPU). The WSPU soon had a **reputation for radical activities**. Its members were given the nickname "**SUFFRAGETTES**" as a joke by a newspaper.



The suffragette colors were purple (for dignity), white (for purity), and green (for hope).

She couldn't have done it without...

NICHOLAS DE CUDORCET (1743–1794) and **OLYMPHE DE GOUGES** (1748–1793) argued for women's rights in France.



The English writer **MARY WOLLSTONECRAFT** (1759–1797) argued that women were not inferior to men.

